

L001: Patient Handover: SBAR Communication

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Lane B — Medical English

Section 1 — Key Vocabulary

1. handover

/ˈhænd,ʊvər/ noun

The transfer of responsibility for a patient from one nurse or team to another.

"The night shift nurse gave a clear handover using the SBAR format."

Tagalog: paglipat ng responsibilidad

2. situation

/ˌsɪtʃuˈeɪʃən/ noun

A brief description of what is happening with the patient right now.

"Situation: Mr. Garcia in Bed 4 is experiencing chest pain."

Tagalog: sitwasyon / kalagayan

3. background

/ˈbæk,ɡraʊnd/ noun

Relevant medical history and context for the patient.

"Background: He has a history of hypertension and was admitted yesterday."

Tagalog: kasaysayan ng pasyente

4. assessment

/əˈsɛsmənt/ noun

Your clinical evaluation of the patient's current condition.

"Assessment: I believe he may be having an acute cardiac event."

Tagalog: pagsusuri / pagtatasa

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5. recommendation

/ˌrɛkəməˈnɛɪʃən/ noun

What you are asking the receiving team to do.

"Recommendation: I recommend an immediate ECG and cardiology consult."

Tagalog: rekomendasyon

6. vital signs

/ˈvaɪtəl saɪnz/ noun phrase

Key measurements of body function: blood pressure, pulse, temperature, respiration.

"His vital signs are BP 160/95, pulse 102, temperature 37.2°C."

Tagalog: mahahalagang palatandaan ng katawan

7. deteriorating

/dɪˈtɪəriəreɪtɪŋ/ adjective

Getting worse; declining in condition.

"The patient's condition has been deteriorating over the last two hours."

Tagalog: lumalala / bumababa ang kalagayan

8. pending

/ˈpɛndɪŋ/ adjective

Awaiting completion or result.

"Blood results are pending — expected within the hour."

Tagalog: naghihintay / hindi pa tapos

Section 2 — Phrases & Patterns

I'm handing over care of...

Opening phrase to begin SBAR handover.

"I'm handing over care of Mr. Santos in Bed 7."

The patient is currently...

Describe present condition.

"The patient is currently stable but requires close monitoring."

My concern is...

Signal your clinical worry clearly.

"My concern is that his oxygen saturation has dropped to 91%."

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I would recommend...

State your action request.

"I would recommend increasing his oxygen flow to 4L/min."

Please note that...

Flag important information.

"Please note that the family has been informed and is on their way."

Section 3 — Scenario Practice

Read the dialogue aloud. Circle any words you found difficult to pronounce.

Nurse A (outgoing): Good morning. I'm handing over care of Mrs. Reyes in Bed 3.

Nurse B (incoming): Go ahead.

Nurse A: Situation: She was admitted last night with shortness of breath. Background: 68-year-old female, history of COPD.

Nurse A: Assessment: Her oxygen saturation has been fluctuating between 88 and 92 percent overnight. I'm concerned about a possible exacerbation.

Nurse A: Recommendation: I recommend continuing the nebuliser every four hours and requesting a chest X-ray this morning.

Nurse B: Understood. Has the doctor been informed?

Nurse A: Yes, Dr. Patel reviewed her at 0400. His notes are in the chart. Vital signs are stable for now.

Section 4 — Self-Evaluation

After completing the exercises, tick each item you feel confident about:

I can explain what SBAR stands for without looking at my notes.

I can use 'situation', 'background', 'assessment', and 'recommendation' in a sentence.

I can describe a patient's vital signs clearly in English.

I can say 'deteriorating' and 'pending' correctly.

I can perform a full SBAR handover for a practice patient.

Section 5 — My Notes

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